

Anika Mahajan

ATLAS Institute
Boulder, Colorado

anika-mahajan.github.io
anika.mahajan@colorado.edu

EDUCATION

University of Colorado Boulder Aug 2024 –
PhD in Creative Technology and Design

University of California, Santa Cruz Sept 2019 – June 2023
Bachelor of Science in Computer Science: Computer Game Design
- Minors: Astrophysics and Computer Science

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

ACME Lab, ATLAS Institute, University of Colorado Boulder
Graduate Research Assistant Aug 2024 –

Center for Transformational Play, Carnegie Mellon University
Research Assistant Jan 2024 – Jun 2024

ALT Games Lab, University of California, Santa Cruz
Undergraduate Research Assistant Oct 2020 – Oct 2023

Creative Coding Lab, University of California, Santa Cruz
Undergraduate Research Assistant Jan 2021 – Apr 2021

PUBLICATIONS

Krithik Ranjan, **Anika Mahajan**, Rishi Vanukuru, and Ellen Yi-Luen Do. (2025). "[The Design Space of Tangible Interfaces for Computational Tinkerability](#)". In *Constructionism 2025*.

Marjorie Ann Cuervo, **Anika Mahajan**, Josh Mao, and Edward Melcer. (2023). "[Try Again?: A Macro-Level Taxonomy of the Challenge and Failure Process in Games](#)". In *IEEE Conference on Games (CoG) 2023*.

Marjorie Ann Cuervo, **Anika Mahajan**, and Edward Melcer. (2021). "[Die-r Consequences: Player Experience and the Design of Failure through Respawn Mechanics](#)". In *IEEE Conference on Games (CoG) 2021*.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Lawrence Livermore National Laboratory, Livermore, CA

NIF Computing Scholar Intern

July - Sept 2022

- Researching and testing new technologies to connect Java and Python at runtime to modernize their image processing

NIF Computing Scholar Intern

June - Sept 2021

- Creating a complete Application Program Interface (API) in Java with full documentation and an example class for the Status Verifier to improve automated testing and increase availability

NIF Computing Scholar Intern

June - Sept 2020

- Redesigning the Status Verifier, a mission critical application, in Java for the National Ignition Facility based on the Model-View-Controller design pattern

UCSC Campus Natural Reserve, Santa Cruz, CA

Automated Camera Trap Processing Internship

Oct - Dec 2020

- Creating an application to automatically detect animal presence within camera trap photos to speed processing of hundreds of camera trap images

HONORS, GRANTS, AND FELLOWSHIPS

RIO Arts and Humanities Grant, CU Boulder – \$3,500

2025

- Principal Investigator: John Keller

Awtar and Teji Singh Fellowship, CU Boulder – \$18,000

2024

Cum Laude, UCSC

2023

Highest Honors in the Major, UCSC

2023

Phi Beta Kappa, Phi Beta Kappa Upsilon Chapter at UCSC

2023

Koret Scholar, Koret Foundation – \$2,000

2022

POSTERS AND TALKS

Designing an augmented reality exoplanet lab app and activity to facilitate interaction and active learning in the planetarium

Physics Education Research Conference (PERC), Washington D.C.

August 2025

Technology as a Medium of Interaction in the Planetarium

Live Interactive Planetarium Symposium (LIPS), Fiske Planetarium

July 2025

Algorithmic Game Theory

OurCS: Women in Tech Workshop, Carnegie Mellon University

Oct 2022

Fail and Retry: A Taxonomy of Player Challenge and Failure in Virtual Reality Games

Koret Slam, University of California, Santa Cruz

May 2022

ORGANIZATIONS

PISEC (*University of Colorado Boulder*) - *Volunteer*

Sept 2025 – Present

Slug Shelter (*University of California, Santa Cruz*) - *Officer*

Jan 2021 – Sept 2021

Girls Who Code - *Member*

Aug 2016 – June 2023